

pragmatics7

Natural-Language Stimuli — Full Catalog

30 unique scenarios, each with a Weak and Strong utterance

Natural-language stimuli (1–4 of 30)

[pvt21_revised0]

Scenario: David and Rachel are watching their favorite hockey team play. As one of their team's players scores, they cheer.

Utterances: Weak = “What an amazing goal!” Strong = “What a miraculous goal!”

Question: How likely is it that this goal is remembered for years to come?

[pvt21_revised1]

Scenario: Joshua and Beverly, who are walking over to a friend's house downtown, come across a group of protesters. Beverly turns to Joshua.

Utterances: Weak = “This crowd looks angry.” Strong = “This crowd looks violent.”

Question: How likely is it that the protest requires riot police?

[pvt21_revised2]

Scenario: William and Katherine are walking through an affluent neighborhood with many mansions. As they stop to admire one mansion in particular, William turns to Katherine.

Utterances: Weak = “Damn, this thing is big!” Strong = “Damn, this thing is huge!”

Question: How likely is it that this mansion has more than 10 rooms?

[pvt21_revised5]

Scenario: Amanda and Paul arrive at a restaurant that does not take reservations. Amanda glances around the dining area and turns to Paul.

Utterances: Weak = “This place is busy!” Strong = “This place is full!”

Question: How likely are Amanda and Paul to wait long for a table?

Natural-language stimuli (5-8 of 30)

[pvt21_revised9]

Scenario: Lucy and Mark return home after a weekend getaway at a resort. As they unpack, Lucy smiles thinking about their accommodations.

Utterances: Weak = "The room we had was quite comfortable." Strong = "The room we had was quite luxurious."

Question: How likely is it that Lucy and Mark stayed at a five-star hotel?

[pvt21_revised10]

Scenario: Linda and Kenneth are sitting around a campfire after a long day of hiking. As the stars begin to twinkle above them, Linda looks to Kenneth.

Utterances: Weak = "It's starting to get a bit cool." Strong = "It's starting to get a bit cold."

Question: How likely is it that Linda puts on an extra layer?

[pvt21_revised11]

Scenario: Daniel and Brenda are having coffee at a trendy café. Brenda just met Daniel's girlfriend for the first time, and she looks pleasantly surprised as she turns to Daniel.

Utterances: Weak = "You didn't tell me she was that cute." Strong = "You didn't tell me she was that beautiful."

Question: How likely is it that Daniel's girlfriend often gets compliments about her looks?

[pvt21_revised14]

Scenario: Bobby is meeting up with his friend Logan. When Bobby sees Logan, he notices that Logan has gotten a new haircut.

Utterances: Weak = "Logan, your hair looks nice!" Strong = "Logan, your hair looks great!"

Question: How likely is Bobby to ask Logan where he got his haircut?

Natural-language stimuli (9–12 of 30)

[pvt21_revised15]

Scenario: Larry and Tina are driving through the countryside. As they pass the farmlands, Larry glances at the ground and turns to Tina.

Utterances: Weak = “This grass looks dry.” Strong = “This grass looks arid.”

Question: How likely is it that this part of the country is experiencing a drought?

[pvt21_revised21]

Scenario: Carl and Laura are at a comedy club, enjoying a night of stand-up performances. At the end of the night, Carl thinks back, chuckles and turns to Laura.

Utterances: Weak = “That last comedian was funny.” Strong = “That last comedian was hilarious.”

Question: How likely is Carl to watch another performance by that last comedian?

[pvt21_revised23]

Scenario: Jose and Jasmine have just attended a charity concert that included several musical performances. As they leave, Jose turns to Jasmine.

Utterances: Weak = “That crowd was noisy.” Strong = “That crowd was loud.”

Question: How likely is it for Jose's ears to still be ringing from the concert?

[pvt21_revised24]

Scenario: Marie and Jordan, two colleagues, are discussing a TED talk they just attended. Jordan asks Marie how she found the talk.

Utterances: Weak = “I liked it.” Strong = “I loved it.”

Question: How likely is it that Marie recommends watching the talk to others?

[pvt21_revised25]

Scenario: Sharon is preparing dinner in the kitchen where her son Jason is trying to help. When Jason walks closer to the stove, Sharon turns to Jason.

Utterances: Weak = “Careful, the pot is hot.” Strong = “Careful, the pot is boiling.”

Question: How likely is Jason to burn himself if he touches the pot?

[pvt21_revised27]

Scenario: Jeremy and Marcus are attending a gaming convention. They're discussing a new game that was showcased during the event, particularly the visuals it offered. Jeremy turns to Marcus.

Utterances: Weak = “The graphics were nice.” Strong = “The graphics were great.”

Question: How likely is the game to receive a five-star rating for its graphics?

[pvt21_revised28]

Scenario: Ronald and Jess are sitting in a conference room brainstorming ideas for a new promotional campaign. After listening to Ronald's latest proposal, Jess turns to Ronald.

Utterances: Weak = “That's a different idea.” Strong = “That's an odd idea.”

Question: How likely is it that Jess has never heard an idea like this before?

[pvt21_revised29]

Scenario: Gerald and Margaret are attending a live musical concert. As the last song finishes, Gerald turns to Margaret.

Utterances: Weak = “That was a good show.” Strong = “That was an excellent show.”

Question: How likely is Gerald to give the musical performance a five-star rating?

[pvt21_revised30]

Scenario: Timothy is visiting his doctor, Dr. Sanders, who is recommending that Timothy go through a minor operation. Dr. Sanders is describing the procedure and its risks.

Utterances: Weak = “It will be uncomfortable.” Strong = “It will be painful.”

Question: How likely is it that the operation will involve some anesthesia?

[pvt21_revised32]

Scenario: Hannah and Jacob just finished a meal at a new restaurant in town. As they are getting ready to pay the bill, Hannah turns to Jacob.

Utterances: Weak = “I like how nice the staff is.” Strong = “I like how polite the staff is.”

Question: How likely is Hannah to leave a larger-than-usual tip?

[pvt21_revised33]

Scenario: Catherine and Charles are visiting a small village during a road trip. After walking up a hill, they arrive at a viewpoint overlooking the entire village. Catherine turns to Charles.

Utterances: Weak = “What a pretty view.” Strong = “What a beautiful view.”

Question: How likely is Catherine to take a photo of the view?

[pvt21_revised34]

Scenario: Max and Judy are sitting in a library, studying for their final exams. Max turns to Judy.

Utterances: Weak = “I like how quiet it is here.” Strong = “I like how silent it is here.”

Question: How likely is it that no talking is allowed in the library?

[pvt21_revised36]

Scenario: Megan and her husband Caleb are on a road trip together. As Megan drives, Caleb turns to her.

Utterances: Weak = "I could eat something." Strong = "I'm hungry."

Question: How likely is it that Caleb asks Megan to get off at the next exit to eat?

[pvt21_revised38]

Scenario: Tiffany and Matthew are academics at a university. Tiffany is expressing her opinion of Matthew's new research idea he just presented at a talk.

Utterances: Weak = "That's a smart idea." Strong = "That's a brilliant idea."

Question: How likely is it that no one has thought of this idea before?

[pvt21_revised39]

Scenario: James and Lauren are looking to have a healthy snack in their kitchen. James picks up a banana, notices its texture, and turns to Lauren.

Utterances: Weak = "This banana is kind of soft." Strong = "This banana is kind of mushy."

Question: How likely is it that the banana has gone bad?

[pvt21_revised40]

Scenario: Albert and Jessica are exploring a historic castle. They come across a wall whose size impresses them. Albert turns to Jessica.

Utterances: Weak = "This wall seems sturdy." Strong = "This wall seems thick."

Question: How likely is it that the wall could resist heavy cannon fire?

[pvt21_revised41]

Scenario: Terry is telling Jenna about a movie he recently watched.

Utterances: Weak = "I found it mediocre." Strong = "I found it bad."

Question: How likely is it that Terry gives the movie a one-star rating?

[pvt21_revised42]

Scenario: Jacqueline and Christian are observing a caterpillar which is resting on a leaf. They are interested in finding out how caterpillars move. Jacqueline turns to Christian.

Utterances: Weak = "Its movements are tiny." Strong = "Its movements are imperceptible."

Question: How likely is it for an average person to not notice the caterpillar's movement?

[pvt21_revised43]

Scenario: Pamela and Bruce are exiting their classroom after having taken an exam. As they walk to their next class, Pamela turns to Bruce.

Utterances: Weak = "That exam was tough." Strong = "That exam was impossible."

Question: How likely is it that Pamela failed the exam?

[pvt21_revised45]

Scenario: Liam and Harper live together and are looking at the weather forecast for tomorrow. Harper looks to Liam.

Utterances: Weak = "Looks like it's going to be warm tomorrow." Strong = "Looks like it's going to be hot tomorrow."

Question: How likely is it that Harper and Liam will use their air conditioning tomorrow?

[pvt21_revised47]

Scenario: Jack has just gone out to buy some milk during which it rained unexpectedly. When Jack returns home, Judith, Jack's partner, looks at him.

Utterances: Weak = “You look damp.” Strong = “You look wet.”

Question: How likely is Jack to change into dry clothes?

[pvt21_revised48]

Scenario: Liam is discussing his daughter's piano recital performance with his colleague Sophie.

Utterances: Weak = “She played well.” Strong = “She played superbly.”

Question: How likely is it that Liam's daughter did not make any mistakes during the recital?